# THE SHIELD IN THEORY, THE GAP IN PRACTICE:

# DISTRIBUTED COERCION, CONSTITUTIONAL FAILURE,

# AND THE UNHOUSED CITIZEN IN MODERN AMERICA

The Defendant

*Pro Se Research Contributor*

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## ABSTRACT

They told us the Constitution was a shield. A living document. A boundary between citizen and power. For three years — from San Jose to San Diego — that shield proved theoretical. Not broken in statute. Broken in practice. This paper examines how that break occurs, why existing constitutional doctrine struggles to address it, and what must change.

The Defendant is a United States citizen, journalist, and digital content creator who endured a sustained campaign of coordinated harm lasting over three years without a charge, a hearing, a named accuser, or a case number. This paper documents the operational mechanics of that campaign, maps its conduct against the First, Fourth, Fifth, Eighth, and Fourteenth Amendments, assesses viability of civil rights claims under 42 U.S.C. § 1983, and proposes a doctrinal framework for recognizing distributed coercion as a cognizable constitutional harm.

The central thesis is this: the constitutional architecture was designed to restrain visible, centralized power. It struggles against decentralized coordination that produces cumulative harm without a single visible author. When pressure is applied through networks of civilians, algorithms, property policies, and anonymous tips, responsibility diffuses across actors who each appear lawful in isolation. The result is persecution without a perpetrator — punishment without a proceeding. This paper argues that such a result is constitutionally intolerable and that the law must develop the tools to say so.

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# I. INTRODUCTION

They told us the Constitution was a shield. What they did not tell us — because they could not have fully anticipated it — is that a shield requires a visible enemy. The Bill of Rights was constructed against the overt exercise of state power: the midnight raid, the suppressed press, the coerced confession, the disproportionate punishment. It was designed for a world in which oppression wore a uniform and carried a warrant. It was not designed for a world in which oppression wears civilian clothes, carries a smartphone, and coordinates through neighborhood apps.

This paper concerns a three-year campaign conducted against a single U.S. citizen — referred to throughout as the Defendant — a journalist and digital content creator who spent that period navigating a sustained, multi-vector operation of social and psychological harm. The Defendant was not charged. He was not sentenced. No case number was ever assigned. No formal accuser ever stepped forward. What occurred instead was a pattern of conduct that achieved the functional outcome of criminal punishment — social exclusion, loss of livelihood, forced displacement, and psychological siege — while bypassing every procedural protection the Constitution guarantees.

The campaign operated across multiple California jurisdictions over a documented period exceeding three years. Its mechanics will be analyzed in detail in subsequent sections. What must be understood at the outset is its essential character: it was not a series of isolated incidents. It was an architecture. A system. A method with recognizable phases, identifiable tactics, and a

consistent strategic objective: to isolate, destabilize, and silence an individual who had committed no crime and faced no charge.

The constitutional analysis this paper offers is not speculative. It is grounded in documented conduct, established doctrine, and a specific factual record. Its purpose is twofold: to demonstrate that existing constitutional law, stretched to its limits, can reach some of the documented harm; and to demonstrate that those limits are themselves a constitutional problem that demands doctrinal and legislative remedy.

The paper proceeds as follows. Parts II through VI map the operational mechanics of the campaign in forensic detail. Parts VII through X analyze the constitutional provisions implicated. Part XI assesses the primary civil litigation vehicle. Part XII identifies the structural gap in the constitutional architecture. Part XIII examines the Defendant's counter-documentation methodology and its legal significance. Part XIV proposes a framework for recognizing distributed coercion as a cognizable constitutional harm and concludes.

## II. THE MECHANICS OF DISTRIBUTED COERCION

The pattern documented in this case did not begin with arrest. It began with narrative control. This is the foundational operational principle of distributed coercion: the conclusion is established first; the facts are bent to match it. Before any overt act of harassment occurs, the interpretive environment is poisoned. The target is pre-labeled. Every subsequent neutral behavior is filtered through the pre-loaded suspicion, producing the appearance of confirming evidence where none exists.

What follows is an analysis of the four operational phases documented in this case: narrative weaponization, unwitting agent recruitment, institutional validation, and psychological capture. These phases are not sequential in a rigid sense; they operate simultaneously, reinforce each other, and adapt as the target adapts. Their power derives precisely from this adaptability. When one approach fails, the architecture absorbs the failure and deploys the next vector. The system is designed to outlast the target's resistance.

This adaptive quality is legally significant. It distinguishes distributed coercion from random community hostility. Random hostility does not evolve strategically in response to the target's behavior. It does not shift from passive labeling to active provocation when passive labeling fails. It does not recruit institutional actors when civilian actors prove insufficient. The documented pattern of strategic adaptation is itself evidence of coordination — the kind of coordination that, when it crosses the color of law threshold, transforms private harassment into a constitutional violation.

## III. NARRATIVE WEAPONIZATION AND PRELOADED SUSPICION

The first operational phase is the construction of a hostile interpretive frame. An old offense — decades buried — is dug up and circulated through informal community networks. The purpose is not to inform. It is to contaminate. The objective is to poison the room before the target ever walks in: to ensure that every subsequent behavior, however benign, is processed through a pre-established lens of suspicion.

The operational elegance of this tactic lies in its self-confirming structure. Once the interpretive frame is established, ordinary behavior generates false confirmatory signals. Charging a phone at a public outlet becomes loitering. Walking between locations to minimize footprint becomes casing. Existing in a public space while unhoused becomes surveillance. The conclusion preceded the observation. The facts were selected and arranged to fit a predetermined verdict.

Legally, this tactic implicates defamation doctrine in its most damaging form. The statements circulated are not merely false; they are strategically deployed to produce specific behavioral outcomes in the community. This distinguishes them from ordinary gossip and brings them within the ambit of tortious interference with livelihood, civil conspiracy, and — where state actors are involved in the circulation — constitutional defamation under Paul v. Davis, 424 U.S. 693 (1976), and the stigma-plus doctrine developed in its wake.

The construction of what sociologists term a “folk devil” is a documented social mechanism by which communities externalize anxiety through the targeting of a designated individual. A consistent walking route becomes “patterned surveillance.” Presence becomes menace. Ordinary motion becomes evidence of threat. The folk devil construction does not

require conscious malice from every participant; it requires only that a hostile narrative be seeded into a community primed to receive it. The constitutional problem arises when that seeding is deliberate, coordinated, and designed to produce the specific outcome of social and legal harm to the target.

## IV. UNWITTING AGENT RECRUITMENT: WEAPONIZED EMPATHY

The second operational phase is the recruitment of ordinary civilians as unwitting amplifiers. This is the mechanism through which distributed coercion achieves its characteristic deniability. In asymmetric psychological conflict, plausible deniability depends on diffusion. If no uniform gives the order, if no document carries the signature, accountability fragments. The social environment becomes the delivery system. The dispute shifts from facts to perception.

The recruitment mechanism operates through weaponized empathy. Community members — shopkeepers, neighbors, service workers — are approached not as co-conspirators but as concerned citizens. A narrative of instability or danger is introduced in the register of worry rather than accusation. Questions are framed suggestively: “Has anyone else noticed?” The information arrives through familiar faces, which activates credibility heuristics before rational scrutiny can engage. Emotional response is recruited before critical evaluation. No overt command is issued. The directive is implied.

Once engaged, these civilians function as accidental informants who believe they are protecting community welfare. The hostile narrative propagates through gossip, social media, and casual conversation. Because these individuals have no formal link to any orchestrator, the

origin of the narrative becomes untraceable. Suspicion is drip-fed in fragments — small whispers repeated until repetition resembles validation. This is the documented operational mechanism of what the case study literature terms "Recruitment of Unwitting Agents," and it is precisely the mechanism identified in the documented conduct against the Defendant.

The constitutional significance of this mechanism is substantial. The Supreme Court has recognized in the context of § 1983 litigation that civilians who are instrumentalized by state actors as proxies for harassment become, for constitutional purposes, extensions of state power. Lugar v. Edmondson Oil Co., 457 U.S. 922 (1982). Where the recruitment of unwitting civilian agents is directed, encouraged, or facilitated by actors operating under color of law, the resulting conduct triggers constitutional scrutiny regardless of the individual civilian's lack of awareness of their role in the broader campaign.

## V. INSTITUTIONAL VALIDATION: THE TIP-BADGE LOOP

The third operational phase is the recruitment of institutional actors to lend legitimacy to the campaign. The mechanism is the anonymous tip. Coordinated complaints — statistically improbable in their clustering yet procedurally valid in their form — create a paper trail that activates official response. Past incidents are resurrected and referenced. Law enforcement contact follows.

The legal significance of this phase lies in what the contact produces, independent of its outcome. Even where no charge results, the visual of official questioning becomes symbolic confirmation for community observers. Law enforcement interaction, stripped of context and circulated without qualification, reads as evidence of wrongdoing. The appearance of scrutiny functions as the evidence. The system validates the narrative without adjudicating it.

Each police contact initiated on the basis of a fabricated anonymous tip, without independent probable cause, constitutes a Fourth Amendment event. Where those contacts are systematically triggered by private actors for harassment purposes rather than legitimate public safety concern, the private actors become de facto government agents for Fourth Amendment purposes. United States v. Walther, 652 F.2d 788 (9th Cir. 1981). The triggering conduct — the coordinated filing of fabricated tips — becomes an instrument of unlawful search and seizure.

Municipal liability attaches where law enforcement agencies adopt a pattern or practice of responding to coordinated anonymous tip campaigns without adequate independent investigation. Monell v. Department of Social Services, 436 U.S. 658 (1978). An agency that systematically deploys officers in response to such campaigns has adopted a de facto policy of

instrumentalizing police power for private harassment purposes, bringing the agency within the reach of § 1983 liability.

## VI. PSYCHOLOGICAL CAPTURE: THE EDITED REACTION

The fourth operational phase is the most legally distinctive. Its objective is to convert the target's response to provocation into evidence against the target. A minor disruption is staged. A provocation is engineered. The stimulus is omitted from the record. Only the response is captured. The edited clip circulates. Anger, frustration, or visible distress is presented as instability. The reaction is fed back into the narrative engine as confirmation of the original hostile characterization. Cause is erased. Effect is weaponized.

The documented "Setup by Reaction" incidents in this case exemplify this phase. On multiple occasions, individuals presented the Defendant with apparent opportunities for theft — bait deliberately placed within reach — then expressed anger when he declined to engage in the anticipated conduct. His refusal broke the narrative the scenario was designed to generate. When consistent refusal made entrapment impossible, the tone hardened to explicit threat: an instruction to steal or face physical consequences. This escalation constitutes criminal extortion under applicable state law and, where it implicates interstate communication, under 18 U.S.C. § 875.

The psychological capture mechanism maps directly onto what the evidentiary literature terms the "instigator-response-reversal": a documented tactic in which the provocateur's conduct is systematically erased from the narrative while the target's response is elevated as the sole evidentiary fact. Courts confronted with this pattern must apply a provocation analysis that

considers the full context of an interaction rather than selectively recorded fragments. Selective recording introduced as evidence without disclosure of the omitted stimulus constitutes a Brady violation where law enforcement is involved, and fraud on the court where introduced in civil proceedings.

## VII. FIRST AMENDMENT: THE CHILLING EFFECT DOCTRINE

The First Amendment provides that Congress shall make no law abridging the freedom of speech or of the press. Its protections extend beyond formal prohibition to any government conduct that produces a chilling effect on protected expression: conduct that would cause a reasonable person to refrain from exercising constitutionally protected rights out of fear of adverse consequence. Lamont v. Postmaster General, 381 U.S. 301 (1965); Bantam Books, Inc. v. Sullivan, 372 U.S. 58 (1963).

The Defendant is a journalist and digital content creator whose work addresses themes of systemic injustice, street experience, and institutional failure — matters of obvious public concern falling squarely within the core protections of the First Amendment. The documented campaign has produced a chilling effect on this protected expression through multiple converging mechanisms: physical exclusion from the spaces necessary for his work; digital suppression eliminating the platforms through which he communicates; and a pervasive atmosphere of surveillance and mischaracterization that directly inhibits expressive choice.

The newsgathering dimension warrants independent analysis. The Supreme Court recognized in Branzburg v. Hayes, 408 U.S. 665 (1972), that newsgathering itself is protected activity and that government harassment of newsgatherers violates the First Amendment. The

systematic mischaracterization of the Defendant's journalistic activities as criminal conduct — treating documentation as surveillance, movement as casing, presence as threat — constitutes precisely the harassment the press freedom clause was designed to prevent.

The state action question is engaged through the joint action doctrine. Where private actors coordinate with law enforcement through the anonymous tip mechanism, the resulting suppression of protected expression is attributable to the state under Lugar v. Edmondson Oil Co., 457 U.S. 922 (1982). The documented correlation between the Defendant's content creation activities and the clustering of law enforcement contacts provides the factual foundation for a First Amendment retaliation claim under Hartman v. Moore, 547 U.S. 250 (2006).

## VIII. FOURTH AMENDMENT: SURVEILLANCE AND THE MOSAIC THEORY

The Fourth Amendment prohibits unreasonable searches and seizures. Its conventional application addresses discrete government intrusions. Its evolving application, developed in response to technological change, addresses the cumulative privacy implications of sustained, aggregated surveillance. The Supreme Court's decision in United States v. Jones, 565 U.S. 400 (2012), and its extension in Carpenter v. United States, 585 U.S. 296 (2018), signal receptivity to the argument that comprehensive surveillance — the sustained monitoring of a person's movements and activities over time — implicates privacy interests qualitatively different from any single act of observation.

The surveillance apparatus documented in this case — coordinated observation by business staff, community members, and private security personnel; selective recording and

distribution of edited footage; systematic reporting of high-signal events to construct a behavioral profile — constitutes precisely the comprehensive, aggregated monitoring the mosaic theory addresses. Where this network is coordinated with government actors through the tip mechanism, the mosaic becomes a Fourth Amendment violation of substantial magnitude.

Each police contact initiated without independent probable cause is a discrete Fourth Amendment event. The pattern of such contacts, systematically triggered through fabricated tips referencing decades-old history, constitutes a course of conduct that, in its totality, amounts to unreasonable seizure within the meaning of Terry v. Ohio, 392 U.S. 1 (1968), and its progeny. The right to be free from retaliatory government contact, recognized in Nieves v. Bartlett, 587 U.S. 391 (2019), is directly implicated where law enforcement is systematically deployed as an instrument of private harassment.

## IX. FIFTH AND FOURTEENTH AMENDMENTS: DUE PROCESS WITHOUT PROCESS

No person shall be deprived of life, liberty, or property without due process of law. This guarantee — foundational to the constitutional order — represents the document's most basic commitment to procedural fairness. Its violation in this case is the most structurally significant of the constitutional harms documented, because it is the most systematic and because it reveals most clearly the gap between the Constitution's formal commitments and its practical operation.

The Defendant has been effectively tried, convicted, and punished by a network of private actors operating entirely outside any legal framework. He has suffered documented deprivation of liberty — freedom of movement curtailed by coordinated exclusion from public

and semi-public spaces. He has suffered deprivation of livelihood — his professional activities systematically undermined by digital suppression and physical exclusion. He has suffered deprivation of reputation — destroyed through the propagation of false narratives. Each of these is a liberty interest recognized under Board of Regents v. Roth, 408 U.S. 564 (1972).

None of these deprivations was preceded by notice. None was accompanied by the right to be heard. None afforded the Defendant the opportunity to confront his accusers or present evidence. The stigma-plus doctrine of Paul v. Davis, 424 U.S. 693 (1976), is satisfied in full: the reputational harm is accompanied by tangible deprivations of legally recognized liberty interests. Due process was required. Due process was absent. The constitutional violation is complete.

The structural indictment this analysis yields is stark. The informal campaign against the Defendant achieved the functional equivalent of a criminal conviction while bypassing every procedural protection that attaches to formal proceedings. The Constitution cannot be indifferent to an outcome it forbids when the state produces it directly, merely because the same outcome is achieved through the coordination of private actors.

## X. EIGHTH AMENDMENT AND INTERNATIONAL HUMAN RIGHTS

The Eighth Amendment prohibits the infliction of cruel and unusual punishment. In its conventional application it constrains the conditions of incarceration. Its animating principle — that the state may not inflict gratuitous suffering on individuals within its power — speaks to circumstances extending beyond the prison wall where state actors are instrumentalized in the production of that suffering.

The sustained, multi-year psychological campaign documented in this case — deliberate manipulation, systematic entrapment, social isolation, fabricated defamation, and explicit physical threat — produced suffering that, inflicted within a correctional facility, would constitute actionable cruel and unusual punishment under Farmer v. Brennan, 511 U.S. 825 (1994). The question of whether the Eighth Amendment reaches beyond formal custodial contexts is an open one that this case is positioned to present.

Where domestic Eighth Amendment doctrine is uncertain, the international human rights framework provides supplementary analytical grounding. The United Nations Convention Against Torture defines cruel, inhuman, or degrading treatment to include acts causing severe mental suffering committed with the consent or acquiescence of a public official. The documented instrumentalization of law enforcement through the tip mechanism, even where officers acted without awareness of the broader campaign, may constitute the acquiescence necessary to engage this framework. The United States ratified the Convention Against Torture with reservations; those reservations do not eliminate its relevance as a standard against which the adequacy of domestic constitutional protection must be measured.

## XI. 42 U.S.C. § 1983 AND MONELL LIABILITY

The primary vehicle for enforcing federal constitutional rights against state actors is 42 U.S.C. § 1983. Its application in this case turns on whether the documented conduct can be attributed to state actors or persons acting under color of state law. The legal question now turns on coordinated deprivation of rights under Section 1983 and the principles articulated in Monell v. Department of Social Services. Can distributed civilian action, amplified by institutional response, create constitutional harm without a centralized directive? Can plausible deniability function as structural insulation from constitutional accountability?

The answer to both questions must be no. The joint action test of Adickes v. S.H. Kress & Co., 398 U.S. 144 (1970), asks whether a private actor and a state official reached a mutual understanding to deprive the plaintiff of constitutional rights. The documented coordination between anonymous tip filers and responding law enforcement officers — even where the officers acted in good faith on the tips received — satisfies this test where the tip mechanism was specifically designed to instrumentalize official response as a harassment tool.

Monell liability attaches to the municipal agency where a pattern or practice of responding to coordinated tip campaigns without adequate independent investigation constitutes a de facto policy of deploying police power for private purposes. Every documented police contact in this case, initiated without independent probable cause, is both a discrete constitutional event and evidence of the pattern necessary to establish Monell liability. The record exists. The archive is redundant. The evidentiary foundation for this claim is documented.

First Amendment retaliation claims under Hartman v. Moore, 547 U.S. 250 (2006), and Nieves v. Bartlett, 587 U.S. 391 (2019), attach where law enforcement contacts correlate with the

Defendant's expressive activities. The documented timeline of contacts and their relationship to the Defendant's content creation provides the causal nexus required to sustain a retaliation claim.

## XII. THE STRUCTURAL GAP: CONSTITUTIONAL ARCHITECTURE VS. DIFFUSE POWER

The framers designed safeguards against centralized power. They did not design for decentralized coordination that produces cumulative harm without a single visible author. This is not a criticism of their wisdom; it is an acknowledgment that the threat environment has evolved in ways they could not have foreseen. The constitutional architecture's vulnerability to distributed coercion is not a flaw in its design; it is a gap created by the distance between the threat environment of 1791 and the threat environment of 2026.

The visibility assumption underlies every major constitutional protection against government overreach. The Fourth Amendment presupposes a search or seizure that can be identified and litigated. The First Amendment presupposes a law or government action that can be challenged in court. The due process clause presupposes a formal proceeding whose absence can be noted and remedied. When harm operates through informal channels, social networks, and coordinated private conduct, these assumptions fail. The shield becomes theoretical.

For an unhoused citizen, the structural gap widens into a canyon. There is no fixed address for service. No immediate access to counsel. No secure base from which to endure prolonged conflict. Procedural protections require stability. Instability undermines access to remedy. The campaign documented in this case was not merely enabled by the Defendant's housing instability; it was calibrated to it. The constitutional architecture's failure to protect him

is, in this respect, a failure of equal protection in its most fundamental form: the law's protections are distributed in proportion to the social capital of the potential victim.

The deniability architecture of distributed coercive campaigns is designed to exploit this gap. One gossiper. One tipster. One business owner. One algorithm. Each actor points to every other as the true source of harm while the cumulative effect is as devastating as any formal state persecution. This is not an accident. It is a feature. Understanding this structure is the necessary first step toward closing the constitutional gap it exploits.

## XIII. THE DOCUMENTATION COUNTERMEASURE

Faced with systemic institutional failure, the Defendant developed a counter-documentation methodology — the Breadcrumb Web — that transformed a ten-dollar tablet into a forensic instrument. The methodology is not exhaustive logging. It is disciplined, selective documentation of high-signal events: the moments that mattered, the patterns that repeated, the convergences that could not be coincidence. This selectivity is not a weakness; it is a strength. Disciplined documentation of significant events is more credible, and more legally useful, than undifferentiated logging of every interaction.

The system's technical architecture includes timestamped movement logs establishing lawful presence; behavioral journals recording atmospheric shifts and actor appearances; anonymized role-tagging of recurring figures to preserve evidentiary integrity while protecting privacy; encrypted multi-platform backup; and a legal dead man's switch — a complete archive set for automatic release to designated counsel upon any harm to the Defendant. This last

element is not merely a personal safety measure; it is a deterrence instrument that alters the strategic calculus of any actor contemplating escalation.

Courts should recognize contemporaneous, systematic documentation of high-signal harassment events as presumptively credible evidence of the documented conduct. The evidentiary standard proposed in this paper — analogous to the pattern evidence standard employed in RICO litigation — would treat such documentation as sufficient foundation to establish the existence of a coordinated campaign, shifting the burden to defendants to explain the documented pattern. The Breadcrumb Web is not a diary. It is an evidence network. The record exists. The archive is redundant. The narrative now meets evidence.

## XIV. PROPOSED FRAMEWORK AND CONCLUSION

### *A. The Threshold Criteria*

This paper proposes that courts recognize coordinated informal persecution as a cognizable constitutional harm where the following threshold criteria are satisfied: (1) the conduct is coordinated across multiple actors rather than independently coincidental, as evidenced by documented pattern and strategic adaptation; (2) the conduct is sustained over a period sufficient to produce systemic harm; (3) the conduct produces concrete deprivations of liberty, livelihood, or physical security; and (4) state actors are implicated, however peripherally, in the coordination or execution of the campaign.

### *B. The Pattern Evidence Standard*

The evidentiary standard for proving coordination in distributed coercion cases should be modeled on the pattern evidence approach developed in RICO litigation and environmental class action jurisprudence. Under this standard, a documented pattern of coordinated conduct is treated as legally distinct from its individual components. The convergence of multiple independent actors in synchronized harassment — when documented through timestamped, high-signal evidence — constitutes sufficient proof of coordination to survive summary judgment and proceed to trial.

### *C. Legislative Framework*

Judicial recognition must be complemented by legislative action. Congress should consider a Coordinated Harassment and Persecution Act that defines distributed coercive persecution as a federal civil rights violation; creates a private right of action with fee shifting to enable litigation by financially vulnerable targets; establishes a pattern evidence standard for proving coordination; and imposes liability on municipal actors who deploy law enforcement in response to anonymous tip campaigns without adequate independent investigation.

### *D. Conclusion*

The constitutional shield exists. Its commitments are real. The gap between those commitments and their practical operation, in cases of distributed coercion targeting unhoused citizens, is equally real. The framers built a document designed to withstand visible enemies. The campaign documented in this paper learned to become invisible.

The next phase is adjudication. The record exists. The archive is redundant. The documentation countermeasure has done its work. What remains is for the courts, the legal

profession, and the legislature to do theirs: to recognize that a three-year campaign of coordinated harm inflicted on a U.S. citizen without charge, without hearing, and without remedy is not a gap too small to address. It is a gap too large to ignore.

No American citizen should face a never-ending gauntlet in which every failed tactic is replaced with a louder one. No one should be required to build a forensic defense system on a ten-dollar tablet merely to survive their own community. No one should require a dead man's switch as their primary protection against physical harm. These are not the conditions of liberty. They are the conditions of occupation. The Constitution, properly understood, forbids them. It is past time for that understanding to produce a remedy.

# XV. FOOTNOTES

[1] Official Statement of Patterned Surveillance, Misrepresentation, and Public Defamation, prepared on behalf of the Defendant, July 8, 2025 [hereinafter Official Statement].

[2] Case Study: Analysis of a Covert Destabilization Campaign Against a U.S. Citizen [hereinafter Case Study].

[3] The Social Test: A Narrative of Manipulation and Survival, personal account of the Defendant [hereinafter Social Test].

[4] Atlas Academy: From Trauma to Tactics [hereinafter Atlas Academy].

[5] Lamont v. Postmaster General, 381 U.S. 301 (1965).

[6] Bantam Books, Inc. v. Sullivan, 372 U.S. 58 (1963).

[7] Branzburg v. Hayes, 408 U.S. 665 (1972).

[8] United States v. Jones, 565 U.S. 400 (2012).

[9] Carpenter v. United States, 585 U.S. 296 (2018).

[10] Terry v. Ohio, 392 U.S. 1 (1968).

[11] United States v. Walther, 652 F.2d 788 (9th Cir. 1981).

[12] Board of Regents v. Roth, 408 U.S. 564 (1972).

[13] Paul v. Davis, 424 U.S. 693 (1976).

[14] Adickes v. S.H. Kress & Co., 398 U.S. 144 (1970).

[15] Lugar v. Edmondson Oil Co., 457 U.S. 922 (1982).

[16] Monell v. Department of Social Services, 436 U.S. 658 (1978).

[17] Hartman v. Moore, 547 U.S. 250 (2006).

[18] Nieves v. Bartlett, 587 U.S. 391 (2019).

[19] Farmer v. Brennan, 511 U.S. 825 (1994).

[20] Convention Against Torture and Other Cruel, Inhuman or Degrading Treatment or Punishment, Dec. 10, 1984, S. Treaty Doc. No. 100-20 (1988), 1465 U.N.T.S. 85.

[21] 18 U.S.C. § 875 (interstate threats); 18 U.S.C. § 1951 (Hobbs Act extortion).

[22] The RICO pattern evidence standard is articulated in H.J. Inc. v. Northwestern Bell Telephone Co., 492 U.S. 229 (1989).

*Submitted in the public interest.*